

Home Away From Home

By Student
Support Squad





**"We are the world, we are the children,
we are the ones who make a brighter
day, so let's start giving"**

- Michael Jackson and Lionel Richie

Agenda

01

Context and
Target Audience

02

Strategy

03

Implications

04

Call to Action



01

**What Context
Does AFS Need
and Who is Our
Target Audience?**

Context



- 92% of international exchange student organizations struggle with host family recruitment (Study Travel Network 2023)
- Policies under new administration
 - Visa revocations and detentions
- 49% of families prioritize global exposure for their children (Survey Center of American Life 2023)

Acting with Urgency



- Shrinking pool of host families
- Increased competition
- AFS's mission aligns with current trends in global exposure

Purpose



- Number of host families decreased from 50 to 29 ~(42%) since 2020
- Recruit 10-15 additional host families

Who is the audience?



Families Participating in Soccer Programs

- **Demographics**
 - Ages 30-50, 4x poverty level (70% of children in sports), children in soccer leagues (CDC)
- **Motivations**
 - Exchange of cultures
 - Educational advantage
 - Community/extracurricular involvement
- **Deterrents**
 - Housing, financial, time concerns
 - Family dynamics
- **Values**
 - Philanthropy, inclusivity, exposure for children to global experiences

Audience Profile

Meet the Smiths

- Family of 4
- Parents ages 35
- Income of \$215,000
- St. Louis suburbs
- Children Sarah and Timmy play soccer
- Prioritize education and new experiences



(Getty Images 2025)





AFS-MOGY's Key Message

AFS MOGY offers an emotionally rich and culturally expansive program that connects your family to the world—through the universal language of soccer. By hosting an international exchange student, you'll not only open your home to global friendship, but also share in the passion for the world's most popular sport. Soccer and AFS MOGY bring people together across borders, creating lasting unforgettable memories. Start your rewarding journey today—host with AFS MOGY!

02 & 03



**What Strategy
Should AFS-
MOGY Use &
What Are the
Implications?**



HOST A STUDENT. CHANGE A LIFE.

Make a lifelong impact
Learn about another culture
Fully supported by AFS



Scan to
Learn More



**AFS AT YOUR LOCAL
SOCCER TOURNAMENT**

LEARN MORE OR CONTACT US

info@afs.org • www.afs.org
(123) 456-7890



Targeted Local Orgs

Starting with Lou Fusz Athletic Midwest
Spring Invitational
April 25-27, 2025

Missouri Rush Mother's Day Classic
May 9-11, 2025

High traffic youth sports communities



The cost to value ratio for the flyers is low.



Relevant Costs Include:

- ~\$890 total for 500 flyers



The Value Includes:

- 90%+ open/read rate
- Builds trust & emotional connection
- Higher engagement than just digital outreach





thank you



Dear Potential Host Family,

[Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur

adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa.

Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus

lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna

eros quis urna. Nunc viverra imperdiet enim. Fusce

est. Vivamus a tellus. Pellentesque habitant morbi

tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac

turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede.]



thank you so much for reading my story. It means

a lot to me that you are considering being an AFS

host family. Your consideration can lead to

changing lives, one student at a time. Please reach

out to AFS volunteers if you have questions!



Sincerely,

Current AFS Student



Purpose: Reaching potential host families through an emotionally appealing medium

Includes: Story (personal, making a difference, soccer cross-cultural connections, other), engaging medium, ease-of-use (e.g. prewritten)

Handwritten Letters

Rationale: Handwritten notes convey personal attention and thoughtfulness (Bundyra 2025)

ROI: Potential host families are emotionally engaged in AFS and touched by words from a current exchange student & AFS students gain volunteer hours

The cost to value ratio for handwritten letters is low.



Relevant Costs Include:

- Paper: Wide Ruled Loose Leaf: \$0.97/Pack of 150
- Markers: \$3.97/10 Pack of Crayola Washable Markers
- Printing Costs: \$30 for Colored Sheets
- Total: 150 letters for \$35.50



The Value Includes:

- Strengthening emotional connection
- Direct messaging from a current exchange student



Phase 3: One-On-One Phone Calls with Potential Host Families



AFS Volunteer Outreach

Short phone calls
from AFS volunteers
to potential hosts



Script & Key Points

Each volunteer
receives a script and
attends a quick
preparation meeting



Intrinsic Persuasion

The phone call will
thank the potential
host and offer help to
any lingering
questions



AFS Phone Call Script

Introduction (haven't met the family yet):

Hello [applicant's name], this is [volunteer's name] from AFS, I heard about your interest in hosting and was wondering if you'd like to talk about it?

Introduction (already met the family):

Hello [applicant's name], this is [volunteer's name] from AFS, how have you been?

Important talking points:

- We are looking to bring more students into the U.S this year by expanding our host families.
- Students have loved going to St. Louis City games, playing soccer with their host siblings, and their US school's soccer program.
- We really appreciate you considering AFS, and would love to have you apply for a hosting position.

Questions to ask:

- How did you guys like the staff and students from our booth?
- Do you need any help with your application?
- Are there any concerns you have that I might be able to help you with?

Purpose: Final persuasion for host families to join AFS

Includes: Speech of gratitude, important talking points, and potential host questionnaire

One-On-One Phone Calls

Rationale: We can connect with these families one last time before they must decide on hosting

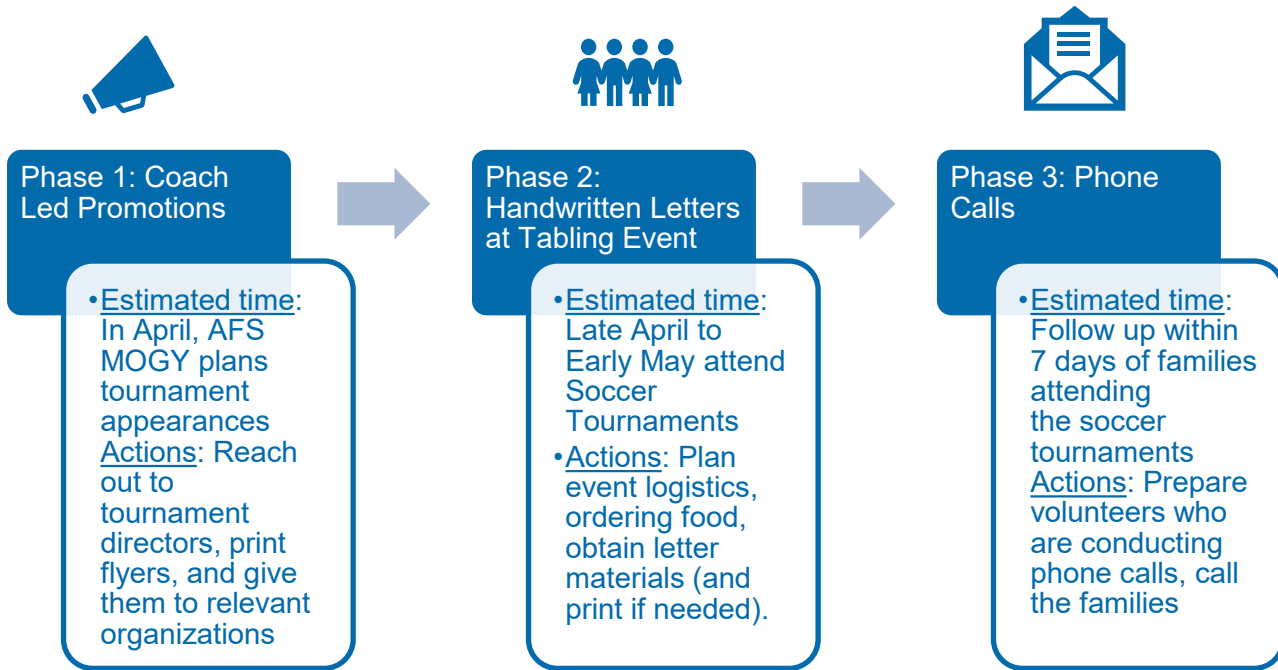
ROI: Potential host families are emotionally engaged in AFS and touched by words from an AFS volunteer, so we can maximize our chances at closing the families

04

What Are The Next Steps?



AFS-MOGY Should Use This Timeline



Executive Summary



Audience

- Families with Children Involved in Soccer Programs



Strategy

- Targeting Local Soccer Tournaments Through Email and Flyers
- Handwritten Letters At Soccer Tournament
- Tabling
- Phone Call Guides During 1-on-1 Phone Calls



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